For data producers, not much has changed. The data producer workflow usually involves capturing the data, then moving it to a storage location and exposing it to data producers. The creation of a new dataset also involves describing the dataset with metadata.

The MVP platform produces a common set of tools for describing, storing, and exposing data, but doesn't make it much easier than what the data producers did before in most cases.

NOTE Platforms have one problem: their value is intrinsic, meaning it applies only to parts already connected to the platform. In our example, the data analyst has an easier time browsing and exploring datasets only after at least two datasets are on the platform. And of course, the value increases a lot by putting more datasets on the platform because the data analyst will eventually have to look only into the platform to find the datasets.

We picked the analyst's workflow because browsing and exploring datasets are also common tasks for development teams that want to use other teams' data, for data scientists, and for ML engineers. As you can see, though, the workflow for data consumers still takes a pretty long time and still involves manually browsing through long CSV files. In our first iteration (described in the following section), we'll try to speed up their processes by leveraging the X-as-a-service idea.

7.2 Improvements with X as a service

Messflix decides to form a small team to take care of the platform for now. Two veteran data engineers start to maintain and develop the platform.

The data analysts responsible for reporting really enjoy the new data mesh and are excited about the new datasets that the Green and Yellow teams provide. Both teams keep on growing their number of datasets and products.

However, a couple of data scientists and machine learners who look at the data only from time to time to identify necessary datasets are having trouble with it. They are having a hard time digging through the CSV-based metadata catalog. In particular, some of the domain data products depend on